

Pitch Scripts + Fallback

Three pitch lengths plus what to do if everything breaks.

30-second pitch (the hook)

Use this when a judge walks up and says "tell me what this is."

*"Every public-college website in Odisha fails accessibility. We built an **open-source layer** - a design system, an Odia-first voice widget, and a compliance scorecard - that any college can plug in. Think **UPI, but for accessibility**. Odisha first. India next."*

Then stop. Let them ask the next question.

60-second pitch (the elevator)

When you have a full minute - intro round, booth conversation.

*"Odisha has over **21 lakh** persons with disabilities and **42 million** Odia speakers. Yet almost every college and government portal in the state is English-first and hard to use for disabled students.*

*We think accessibility shouldn't be 200 separate broken projects. It should be **shared public infrastructure** - like UPI.*

***AaaS is three things:** a design system every component is accessible by default; an assistive widget with Odia voice, translation, dyslexia mode, and captions; and a compliance dashboard a college can run against its own site. It's Apache 2.0, on-prem capable - student data never leaves the college.*

We want to pilot at one Odisha institution. Adopt it. Fork it. Watch the rest of the state follow."

2-minute pitch (panel round)

Use this when you have the full floor.

1. Open with a person.

"Picture Priyanka. Blind, class 12, Puri, speaks only Odia. Next week she has to fill an online admissions form for Utkal University. Today that form defeats her - the labels aren't linked, the captcha is an image, the page is in English, the errors flash and disappear. She asks her brother to fill it for her. Half of Odisha's disabled students do the same."

2. Scale it up.

"Odisha has 21 lakh persons with disabilities. 42 million Odia speakers. 15 state universities. 200+ BPUT colleges. Every one of them legally owes accessibility under the RPwD Act - and almost none of them deliver it."

3. Name the failure pattern.

"The reason it keeps failing: every college treats accessibility as a per-project checkbox. They hire a vendor, bolt on an 'overlay' widget, tick the box, move on. It doesn't work. And no one measures it."

4. Our answer.

"Accessibility has to become infrastructure, not remediation. Three pieces. A React design system - every component WCAG 2.2 AA at commit time, Noto Sans Oriya bundled. A testing harness so every pull request is measured. An assistive widget - Odia voice in, Odia voice out, translation, dyslexia mode, captions - all on-prem. Apache 2.0, DPDP-compliant, deployable on a single VM at OCAC."

5. Close.

"We named the team SUBARNAREKHA - the river that carries gold downstream to everyone on its banks. That's the intent. Accessibility shouldn't belong to whoever hires the best vendor. It should belong to every Odia speaker, and then to every Indian. Odisha first. India next."

Phrases to say (words the judges like)

- **Digital public infrastructure** - not "SaaS platform".
- **Odia-first** - not "multilingual".
- **Assistive services layer** - never "overlay" (it's a slur in the accessibility community).
- **Aligned with 5T and Mo Sarkar** - whenever the judge is from government.
- **On-prem at OCAC's data centre** - sounds more concrete than "on-prem".
- **Open source, Apache 2.0** - say this early. It changes the room.

Phrases to avoid

- "AI-powered" as a standalone claim. Always name the model (MMS-TTS, NLLB, IndicWav2Vec).
- "Solves accessibility." We *enable* it. We don't *solve* it.
- "Disabled people." Say "people with disabilities" or be specific (blind, Deaf, dyslexic).
- "Simple" or "easy." Accessibility is never simple. Judges know it.

If everything breaks - your emergency script

If the laptop dies, if Wi-Fi is off, if the demo crashes - you still have the pitch. Follow these three steps in order.

- **Acknowledge once.** "Looks like the stack is under load - let me take you through it without the demo." *Don't apologise twice.*
- **Pivot to the 60-second pitch.** You have it memorised. Deliver it. Eye contact.
- **Point to the repo.** "Apache 2.0, it's all live - QR code on the table. Everything I just described exists and the code is public."

If your mind goes blank in the Q&A;

Use this line. It buys you 10 seconds and is completely honest:

"That's a good question - let me think about it for a second."

Judges appreciate pause more than they appreciate rambling. Take a breath. Then give a short answer - 2 sentences is enough.

The one thing to remember

You don't need to know every technical detail. You need to know **three names** (Priyanka, Arun, Meera), **five numbers** (21 lakh, 42 million, 200 colleges, WCAG 2.2 AA, Apache 2.0), and **one tagline** ("UPI of accessibility - Odisha first, India next").

That's it. Everything else is conversation.